

Platinga has argued, a warranted belief, and that therefore corresponds to true knowledge, if the object of that belief is true. The traditional apologetic arguments for the existence of God function in this area.

On the other hand, the historical consideration of the person of Jesus is related to the question of revelation, since all the basic facts of the Christian faith lead to Christ as the culminating point in the process of self-revelation by God in History.

Therefore, if a God who created all things exists, and if He decided to reveal Himself to us in Christ, it is perfectly reasonable to infer that He also delivered and preserved a written revelation for us.

In other words, the only premise that is added to the basic facts of the Christian faith by inference is the preservation of the Text of the New Testament. That is to say, Dr. Pickering's Trinitarian theism presupposes not only the God who is Creator, Redeemer and Provider, but adds to God's Providence, by a simple rational inference, the preservation of the New Testament Text.

However all that may be, it is important to note that although I assigned the proof of 1) to traditional apologetics, and that in addition 2) may reasonably be inferred on the basis of 1), the fact remains that, for the purpose of analyzing the argument, proposition 3) follows from 1) and 2). Therefore, the whole validity of the argument depends only on proving 4); that is to say, that the text of Family 35 is the only text type of the New Testament that can be demonstrated objectively as having been preserved. It is here that Dr. Pickering's work comes into play.

It is precisely at this point, the demonstration of proposition 4), that Dr. Pickering's work ceases to be merely presuppositional and becomes empirical, analyzing the evidence in an objective way, something that any respectable contemporary scientist tries to do.

That is, the demonstration of the antiquity and the independence of the text of Family 35 is based on objective arguments and on a comparison of the evidences (all the extant manuscripts). In this area as well, Dr. Pickering's work is incomparable.

Taking advantage of the correlation with apologetics, I can state that Dr. Pickering's work with the evidences, just like